

MOTIVATION



Course instructor:
Dr Shweta Chawak
Humanities and Social Sciences
Indian Institute of Technology Bombay

RECAP

- Motivation is what “moves” people to do the things they do
- Types of Motivation
 - Extrinsic
 - Intrinsic
- Evolutionary – Instincts
- Drive reduction theory: Needs – psychological tension called drive – reduce tension
 - Primary drive: bodily needs
 - Acquired (secondary) drive: experience
- Types of needs
 - Biological
 - Psychological
- Hunger: Most primary needs
 - Physical factors: hormones and brain
 - Social components

Biological Needs: Hunger (Cont'd...)

Social components:

- Conditioning
- Appeal of food: external features of food rather than the internal hunger
- Cultural factors: food portion differences
- Gender norms: practices where women eat last and least
- Escape or a comfort in times of stress: immediate pleasure

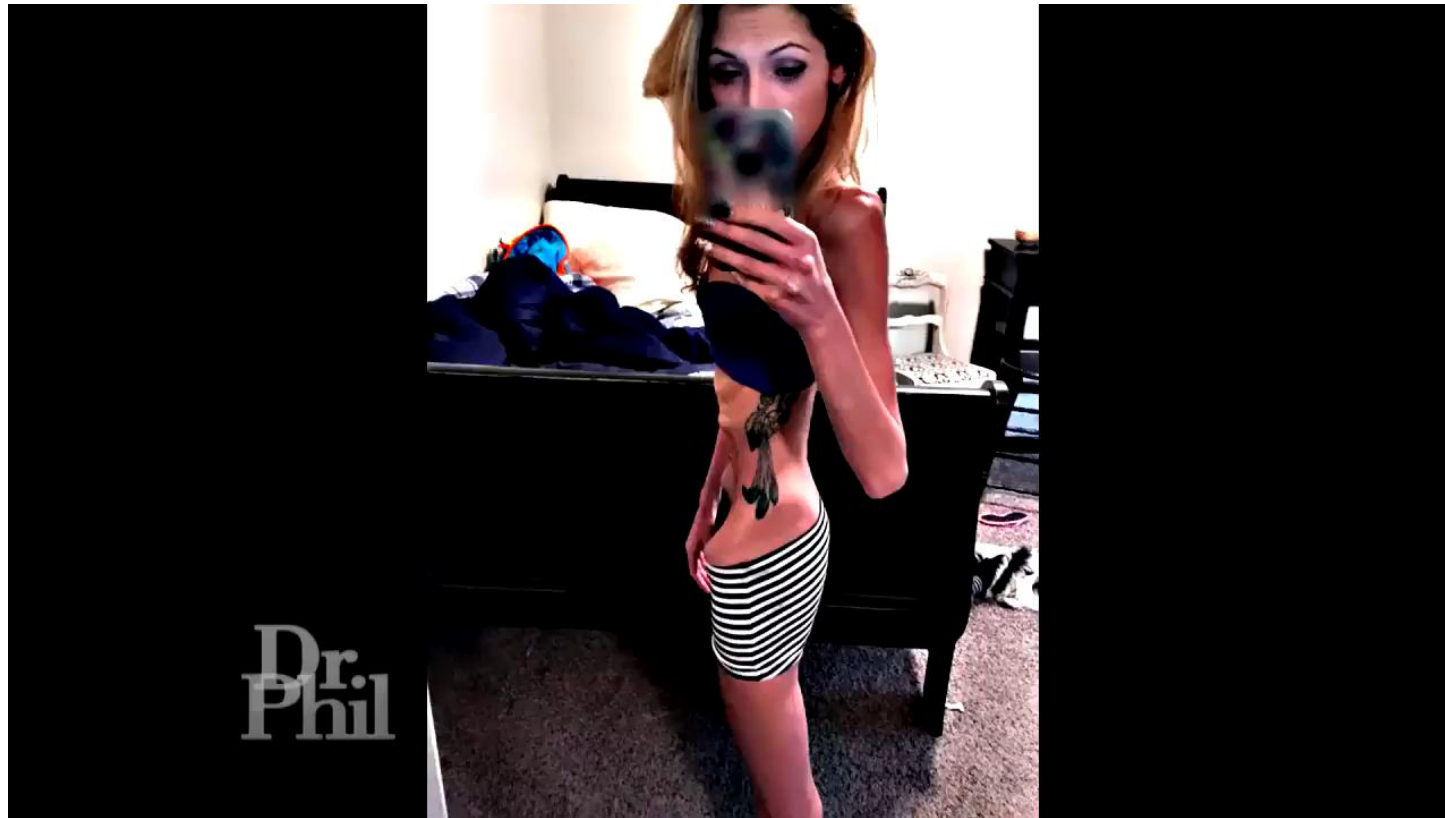




Biological Needs: Hunger (Cont'd...)

Eating disorders:

- **Anorexia nervosa:** severe eating disorder in which people may refuse to eat while denying that their behavior and appearance—which can become skeleton-like—are unusual



@Dr Phil

Biological Needs: Hunger (Cont'd...)

Eating disorders:

- **Bulimia:** A disorder in which a person binges on large quantities of food, followed by efforts to purge the food through vomiting or other means
- Brain scans show that individuals with eating disorders process information about food differently from healthy individuals
- Genetic factors that cause chemical imbalance
- Social beauty norms
- Overly demanding parents or family issues

Arousal Theory



Psychosocial Needs



Hierarchy of Needs

Psychosocial Needs: Arousal Theory

- People have an **optimal** (best or ideal) level of tension
- The tension is maintained by increasing or decreasing stimulation
- Task performance: severe anxiety versus boredom
- Moderate level of arousal is the best

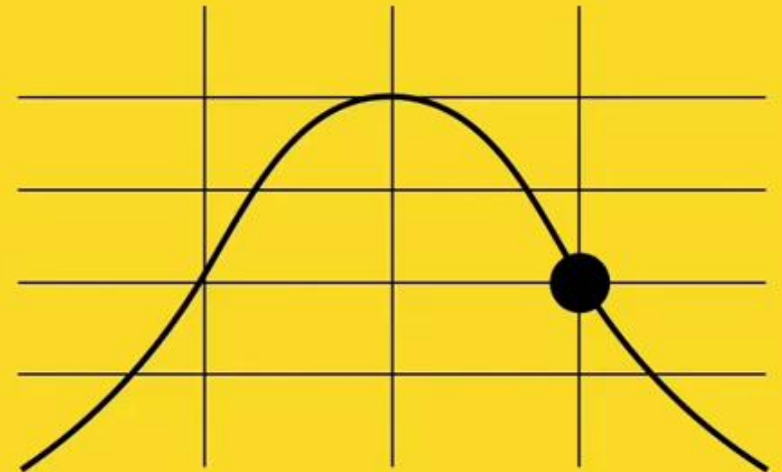
Yerkes-Dodson law

- When tasks are simple, a higher level of arousal leads to better performance
- When tasks are difficult, lower levels of arousal lead to better performance

Easy tasks = “high–moderate” level for optimal performance
Difficult tasks = “low–moderate” level for optimal performance



The Yerkes-Dodson Law



Psychosocial Needs: Arousal Theory (cont'd...)

Romantic partners who are under aroused may pick a fight with their spouse



Highly anxious students may try to reduce anxiety to improve test performance



Students with no anxiety may lack motivation to study, lowering performance



A **sensation seeker** is someone who requires higher arousal and craves more complex, varied sensory experiences than others



Presence of others can enhance or hinder an individual's performance
Adolescents often take riskier decisions in groups due to peer pressure compared to when they are alone



Psychosocial Needs: Arousal Theory (cont'd...)

Strengths

- **Clear explanation of basic motivation:** Explains how biological needs create drives that push behavior to reduce tension and restore balance (homeostasis)
- **Applicable across species:** Relevant for both humans and animals, providing a general framework for understanding motivated behavior

Drawbacks

- **Cannot explain all behaviors:** Fails to account for behaviors that increase arousal or tension, such as curiosity-driven acts, or long-term goal pursuits that temporarily increase discomfort (e.g., studying hard)
- **Ignores cognitive and social factors:** Overlooks the role of thoughts, beliefs, social motivations, and cultural influences on human behavior